

JAPAN

FEATURED REPORT

Detains migrants or asylum seekers?	Has laws regulating migration-related detention?	Migration Detainee Entries	Total Migration Detainees	Refugees	Asylum Applications
Yes	**Yes**	**15,334** 2024	**16,595** 2023	**29,068** 2024	**31,293** 2024

OVERVIEW

Although its foreign-born population is very small compared to that of other immigration destination countries, Japan has struggled to overcome widespread public anxieties about foreigners and develop ways to meet migrant labour needs. One strategy has been to reduce non-nationals in irregular situations while accelerating immigration of skilled workers. An important tool used to implement this policy has been mandatory detention of over-stayers and other unauthorized migrants. Many of the country's detention practices—including indefinite detention, lack of transparency regarding detention at ports of entry, and the detention of asylum seekers—have been repeatedly criticised by the international community as well as national civil society.



Types of facilities used for migration-related detention

Administrative · Ad Hoc · Criminal · Unknown

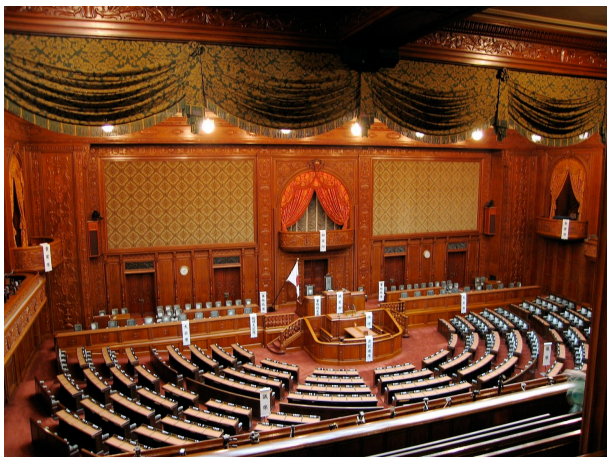
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A Missed Opportunity in Japan

27 April 2023

On 7 March, Japan's cabinet passed a bill amending the country's immigration and asylum legislation. The bill, which has been slated by rights groups, reinforces the country's ability to indefinitely detain migrants and asylum seekers. It is now due to be voted on by the country's parliament. With regards to detention, the amendment bill to […]

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Japan: Covid-19 and Detention

21 September 2022

Japan's treatment of refugees, asylum seekers, and migrants within its immigration detention estate is again under intense scrutiny after a court ruled that authorities had failed to protect the health of a detainee. The detainee – a 43-year-old Cameroonian asylum seeker – died in detention in 2014. Suffering from diabetes and other health issues, the […]

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Japan: Covid-19 and Detention

21 May 2021

Japan's immigration detention system has recently come under renewed scrutiny. In particular, the 6 March death of a 33 year old Sri Lankan woman–Ratnayake Liyanage Wishma Sandamali–who died in the Nagoya Regional Immigration Bureau Detention House following months of health complaints, sparked a wave of criticism and drew international attention. Sandamali had been detained since […]

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Japan: Covid-19 and Detention

8 November 2020

According to NGO sources, there has been a decrease in arrests and detention orders in Japan during the pandemic. According to the Forum for Refugees Japan (FRJ), the number of detainees had decreased to around 520 by July, compared to 1,054 in April 2020. Additionally, the International Detention Coalition (IDC) reported that 563 asylum seekers […]

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Japan: Covid-19 and Detention

9 April 2020

According to a lawyer who represents immigration detainees in Japan, to date the Immigration Services Agency has taken no action to safeguard or release detainees. This has prompted NGOs and advocates in the country to issue an appeal on the Immigration Review Task Force



Facebook page demanding urgent action by the government. […]

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Global Detention Project
1-3 rue de Varembé, 1202 Geneva, Switzerland
t: +41 22 7330897
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Stop arbitrary detention of migrants, refugees, and asylum seekers



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